UNIT 2.4 · WORK SKILLS



BUSINESS PARTNER A2

Making Agreements

NEGOTIATING AN IT SUPPORT CONTRACT | A2–B1 |
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LESSON OUTCOME

By the end, you can close a simple deal

- [ ] Ask clear questions about an IT service.
- [ ] Answer a client's questions politely.
- [ ] Say yes and say no without losing the deal.
- [ ] Confirm details and agree a price.

Lead-in: Does your company or school have IT support? What do IT technicians do?

VIDEO 2.4.1 · QUESTION AND ANSWER

Match the questions with the answers

QUESTIONS

1 What do you want the technician to do, exactly?

2 Can the technician back up the files?

3 Do you want us to repair the printers?

4 How many technicians are there?

QUESTIONS

5 How much time does the team need?

6 Does the price include the software licences?

7 How much is that?

8 When can the team start?

ANSWERS

a It's usually two technicians for an office this size.

b About three hours a day.

c How about next Monday?

d Yes, of course.

ANSWERS

e No, we have a specialist company for the printers.

f Install the software, set up the computers and check the network.

g No, it doesn't. There's a small charge for those.

h It's two hundred and fifty pounds a week.

SPEAKING · LANGUAGE BANK A

Asking about the company's service

- How many **technicians / engineers** are there?
- Can **you / your team** do that?
- Can you **provide** the software licences?
- Does the price **include** the licences?
- How about **coming before / after** 8 o'clock?
- How much **time** do you need?
- How much is that **for fifteen hours** a week?
- When can **your team** start?

Swap the words in bold: *engineers, devices, cables, maintenance, cybersecurity*.

SPEAKING · LANGUAGE BANK B

Asking the client questions

What do you want **the technician** to do, exactly?

How many **days / hours** do you need the service?

What time do you want **the team** to come?

Is there a place for the **equipment / server**?

How about **on Monday**?

Is **three hours a day** enough for you?

Notice the pattern: **What do you want + person + to do? · How many + hours + do you need?**

RESPONDING

Saying yes and saying no

✓ SAYING YES

> Yes, we can.

> Yes, it does.

> Yes, that's fine.

> Yes, that's right.

> Yes, of course.

Short, clear, then move to the next detail.

− SAYING NO

> No, we can't. I'm sorry.

> No, it doesn't. I'm sorry.

> No, we don't — we have a specialist company.

> No, but we can offer something else.

Always add a reason or an alternative. Never just "No".

STRATEGY

From "no" to "not yet"

A refusal is not the end of the meeting. Keep the deal alive.

01 **Refuse the item, not the client**
"No, we can't repair the printers — but we can check the network."

02 **Ask a question instead**
"What if we try two hours a day instead of three?"

03 **Give the reason**
"That might be difficult — the licences cost extra."

04 **Confirm what you both agree**
"So, the setup and the backups — yes. The printers — no."

Can you make a deal?

If you can ask, refuse politely and confirm, you can.